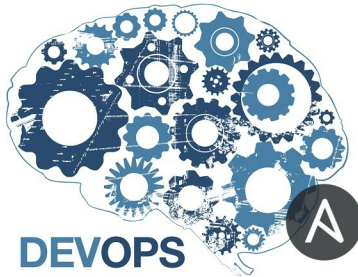


The DevOps Series

An Introduction to Ansible



With this article, we begin a new series on DevOps, starting out with Ansible, which helps you to build a strong foundation. As the Ansible website proclaims, proudly, “Deploy apps. Manage systems. Crush complexity.”

Ansible is an IT automation tool that is used for provisioning, configuration, deployment and managing infrastructure. The project was first released in 2012, and is written in Python. The main objective of the tool is to be simple and easy to use. It is based on an agent-less (push-based) architecture, and the playbooks are written in plain English. It also supports pull-based deployments Ansible has had pull support since 2012 and uses SSH to execute commands on remote machines. It is available under the GNU General Public License.

Installation

You can install Ansible using your GNU/Linux distribution package manager.

On Fedora, you can use Yum to install Ansible, as follows:

```
$ sudo yum install ansible
```

If you are using RHEL or CentOS, install the `epel-release`, and then use the Yum command to install Ansible.

On Ubuntu, you need to add the `ppa` repository before installing the tool, as shown below:

```
$ sudo apt-get install software-properties-common
$ sudo apt-add-repository ppa:ansible/ansible
```

```
$ sudo apt-get update
$ sudo apt-get install ansible
```

The Ansible documentation encourages Debian users to access the Ubuntu repository to obtain Ansible. You need to add the following line to `/etc/apt/sources.list`:

```
deb http://ppa.launchpad.net/ansible/ansible/ubuntu trusty main
```

You can then install the software using the following commands:

```
$ sudo apt-get update
$ sudo apt-get install ansible
```

The Parabola GNU/Linux-libre distribution is a derivative of Arch Linux, without the binary blobs. You can install Ansible using the `pacman` utility:

```
$ pacman -S ansible
```

The latest Ansible version 2.2 (as of date) is what we will use in this article. Ansible is also available for BSD variants, Mac OS X, and Windows. You are encouraged to refer to the Ansible documentation for more information.